

THE LAST SHIFT

A Psychological Journey Through Attachment and Distance

Lalit R. Mishra

Copyright © 2025 Lalit R. Mishra

All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, distributed, stored, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except for brief quotations used in reviews or scholarly references.

THE LAST SHIFT

A Psychological Journey Through Attachment & Distance

First Edition

Written by Lalit R. Mishra

This book is a work of psychological reflection and literary exploration. Any resemblance to actual persons, events, or experiences is purely coincidental. The content is intended for informational and literary purposes only and should not be considered professional psychological, medical, or therapeutic advice.

DEDICATION

For everyone who kept carrying emotions
they never had the words to explain.

And for the version of you
that survived every chapter
without knowing
it was becoming stronger.

AUTHOR'S NOTE

This book is not about one person.

It is not about one relationship.

It is not about one ending.

It is about the silent psychological shifts that happen inside people when attachment, distance, expectations, loneliness, and self-awareness slowly reshape the way they experience life.

Some chapters may feel familiar.

Some may feel uncomfortable.

Some may feel like they were written from your own thoughts.

If that happens, remember:

You are not reading this book to find answers.

You are reading it to observe the questions that were already there.

Welcome to The Last Shift.

CONTENTS

Dedication	4
Author's Note	5
Prologue	6
Introduction	7
PHASE I — ATTACHMENT	
Chapter 1 — The Beginning of Attachment	13
Chapter 2 — Silent Attachment	18
PHASE II — DISTANCE	
Chapter 3 — Fear of Losing	23
Chapter 4 — Emotional Exhaustion	30
PHASE III — DETACHMENT	
Chapter 5 — Detachment (The Quiet Disappearance)	35
Chapter 6 — Emotional Shutdown	39
PHASE IV — VOID	
Chapter 7 — Isolation (Self-Distance)	49
PHASE V — AWARENESS	
Chapter 8 — The Mind Questions Itself	57
Chapter 9 — The Things We Realize Too Late	66
PHASE VI — THE LAST SHIFT	
Chapter 10 — The Last Shift	73

Epilogue	79
PART II — SECOND LAYER	82
About the Author	83

PROLOGUE

Kabhi kabhi insaan suddenly change nahi hota.

Woh dheere dheere internally shift hota hai.

Pehle sab normal lagta hai.

Routine same hoti hai.

Log same hote hain.

Conversations bhi.

Par phir ek point ke baad mind cheezon ko sirf experience nahi karta...

unhe notice karna start karta hai.

Kis message ka wait rehta hai.

Kis silence se mood affect hota hai.

Kis person ki energy pure day influence kar deti hai.

Aur bina realise kiye

mind continuously internally active rehna start kar deta hai.

Shuru mein yeh awareness normal lagti hai.

Insaan sochta hai

woh bas emotionally mature ho raha hai.

Par dheere dheere thoughts background noise banne lagte hain.

Same conversations replay hoti rehti hain.
Same situations mentally analyse hoti rehti hain.
Aur ek point ke baad insaan tired feel karta hai...
without understanding exactly why.
Kyuki externally kuch major wrong nahi hota.
Par internally mind kabhi properly rest nahi karta.
Aur shayad sabse strange part yeh hota hai:
insaan duniya se pehle
khud ko observe karna start karta hai.
And once that happens...
everything changes quietly.
Not outside.
Inside.

INTRODUCTION

Strange how humans work na...

Puri life connection dhundte rehte hain, someone who finally feels like home.

But the moment we actually get attached to someone, fear quietly enters the room.

Fear of losing them.

Fear of being replaced.

Fear of caring more than the other person does.

Shayad isi liye bahut log emotionally close hone ke baad bhi thoda distance maintain karte hain.

Not because they don't care...

but because somewhere deep inside they already know how painful attachment can become.

Kuch log life se chale jaate hain loudly.

Aur kuch log physically present hote hue bhi emotionally disappear ho jaate hain.

Honestly...

the second one hurts more.

The scary thing about attachment is that a person slowly becomes part of your everyday life.

Unke texts, unki presence, unki energy...

sab normal lagne lagta hai.

Aur phir ek din unki absence pura atmosphere change kar deti hai.

Tab samajh aata hai ki attachment sirf love nahi hota.

Sometimes it's emotional dependency hidden behind comfort

Maybe that's why people say,

“Don't get too attached.”

But humans were never meant to stay emotionally detached forever.

Deep down, everyone just wants someone who feels like peace in this noisy world.

**PHASE I —
ATTACHMENT**

CHAPTER 1 — THE BEGINNING OF ATTACHMENT

Nowadays attachment itni naturally ho jaati hai ki logon ko pata hi nahi chalta ki kab koi person unki life mein thoda zyada important ho gaya.

Koi dramatic beginning nahi hoti.

Koi exact moment nahi hota jahan insaan suddenly realize kare:

"Yes... I'm attached now."

It usually starts with small things.

Bahut small things.

Random conversations turning into daily conversations.

Ek naam jo pehle bas ek naam tha, ab thoda familiar lagne lagta hai.

Ek notification jo pehle normal lagta tha, ab bina reason attention grab karne lagta hai

Aur phir bina realize kiye, kisi ki presence aapki routine ka part banne lagti hai.

Not because you planned it.

Not because you were looking for it.

It just happens.

Quietly.

Shayad isi liye attachment ko identify karna itna difficult hota hai.

Kyuki jab woh start hota hai, tab woh attachment jaisa feel hi nahi hota.

Woh bas comfort lagta hai.

Familiarity lagti hai.

Ek achhi habit lagti hai.

Jaise kisi din achanak realize ho ki subah uthte hi tumhara haath bina soche phone ki taraf chala gaya.

Kisi message ko check karne ke liye nahi.

Bas dekhne ke liye ki kuch aaya hai ya nahi.

Aur phir ek point ke baad aap notice karte ho ki unke messages mood affect karne lage hain.

Unki presence achhi lagti hai.

Unka attention matter karne lagta hai.

Aur unki absence...

Strangely noticeable ho jaati hai.

Even when you pretend it isn't.

The scary thing is that attachment kabhi ek hi din mein strong nahi hota.

Woh countless small moments se banta hai.

Tiny conversations.

Shared jokes.

Daily check-ins.

Ordinary interactions that slowly stop feeling ordinary.

Aur shayad isi liye jab attachment grow karta hai, toh insaan us growth ko notice bhi nahi kar pata.

Because nothing feels different.

Until one day... something does.

One dry text changes the mood.

One late reply creates overthinking.

Kabhi kabhi insaan khud ko convince bhi karta hai ki it doesn't matter.

Phir bhi woh chat dobara open karta hai.

Kuch seconds dekhta hai.

Close kar deta hai.

Aur kuch minutes baad bina reason phir wahi conversation dekh leta hai.

Even a small distance suddenly starts feeling heavy...

Like something shifted, but nobody said it out loud.

Aur tab insaan pehli baar khud ko observe karna start karta hai.

"Main itna affected kyun ho raha hoon?"

"Main itna wait kyun kar raha hoon?"

"Mere mood ka control kisi aur ke actions ke paas kab chala gaya?"

Strange thing is...

Most people think attachment is just about caring.

But attachment rarely feels dangerous in the beginning.

Because it doesn't arrive as pain.

It arrives as comfort.

As familiarity.

As someone you enjoy having around.

Aur shayad isi liye log us shift ko miss kar dete hain.

They think they're just caring a little more.

Until one day they realize they're thinking about someone far more than they're thinking about themselves.

A person who once occupied a few minutes of your day... starts occupying space inside your mind.

Kabhi conversation khatam ho jaati hai.

Lekin mind nahi karta.

Woh usi baat ko dobara revisit karta rehta hai.

Usi tone ko.

Usi message ko.

Usi feeling ko.

And that's where things slowly begin to change.

Because attachment itself isn't the problem.

The problem begins when your emotional balance starts depending on something you cannot control.

Someone else's attention.

Someone else's presence.

Someone else's consistency

Aur us point par insaan usually do cheezon mein se ek karta hai.

Ya toh woh khud ko aur zyada us attachment mein invest kar deta hai.

Ya phir pehli baar ruk kar khud ko dekhna start karta hai.

Maybe that's why attachment feels so beautiful... and so risky at the same time.

It reminds us how deeply humans can connect.

How deeply they can care.

But it also reminds us how quietly people can drift away from themselves while holding on too tightly to someone else.

Aur shayad attachment ka real beginning wahi hota hai.

Not when someone becomes important.

But when their presence starts carrying more emotional weight than you ever intended to give it.

CHAPTER 2 —

SILENT ATTACHMENT

Silent attachment usually start hi itna casually hota hai ki logon ko samajh bhi nahi aata ki unke beech kuch change ho raha hai.

No announcement.

No definition.

No labels.

Bas do log baat karte karte emotionally close aa jaate hain
Pehle conversations normal lagti hain.

Light.

Random.

Easy.

Kuch bhi special nahi.

Phir dheere dheere conversations important lagne lagti hain.

Not because topic change ho gaya.

But because person matter karne lagta hai.

Ek specific notification mood affect karne lagta hai.

Ek specific naam screen par dikhte hi attention automatically us taraf chala jaata hai.

Aur bina realize kiye insaan kisi ki presence ka emotionally habitual ho jaata hai.

Jaise woh person daily life ka official part na hoke bhi uska part ban chuka ho.

Shayad isi liye silent attachment dangerous bhi hota hai.

Because everything happens quietly.

No confession.

No relationship.

No defined space.

Aur phir bhi emotions itne deep ho jaate hain ki even small distance noticeable lagne lagti hai

Outside, everything looks casual.

"We're just friends."

"It's normal."

"There's nothing like that."

Aur shayad dono log ye baat sach mein believe bhi karna chahte hain.

Lekin phir kuch choti choti cheezein normal nahi lagti.

Unka online aana notice hona.

Reply aane se pehle chat khol lena.

Ek dry message ko baar baar padhna aur sochna,

"Sab theek hai na?"

Woh cheezein friendship se zyada feel hone lagti hain.

Even if nobody says it.

Aur wahi silent attachment ka strange part hai.

Bahar se sab same dikhta hai.

Andar se sab slowly change ho raha hota hai.

Ek dusre ki energy notice karna.

Mood notice karna.

Silence notice karna.

Aur phir normal act karna jaise kuch affect hi nahi hua.

Like nothing is happening internally.

Shayad silent attachment ka sabse complicated part bhi wahi hota hai.

A person starts feeling emotions jinke upar officially uska koi right hi nahi hota.

But emotionally woh already involved hota hai

Jealousy without commitment.

Expectations without promises.

Pain without explanations.

Aur kai baar dono log same feelings carry kar rahe hote hain.

Lekin ek person silent rehta hai because he's afraid of losing the connection.

Aur doosra silent rehta hai because he's afraid of rejection.

Because once feelings are spoken out loud, everything can change.

Permanently.

Aur kuch log connection lose karne se itna darte hain ki they choose confusion over clarity.

At first, confusion manageable lagti hai.

Phir woh routine ban jaati hai.

Aur dheere dheere emotionally exhausting lagne lagti hai.

Jisko clarity mil jaati hai, woh emotionally calm reh leta hai.

Lekin jisko sirf silence aur mixed signals milte rehte hain... uske andar questions quietly build hone lagte hain.

"Kya main hi zyada feel kar raha hoon?"

"Kya ye sirf meri side se hai?"

"Kya main overthink kar raha hoon?"

Aur jab questions answers se zyada ho jaate hain...

tab frustration slowly enter karna start karti hai.

Isi liye kuch log emotionally distant ho jaate hain.

Kuch unusually quiet.

Kuch unnecessary cold.

Not because they stopped caring.

But because caring silently for too long starts becoming heavy.

Bahut heavy.

Maybe that's why silent attachment itna confusing hota hai.

Kyunki usme heartbreak hamesha kisi ending se nahi aata.

Kabhi kabhi heartbreak sirf itna hota hai ki feelings grow karti rehti hain...

aur clarity kabhi grow nahi karti.

Aur shayad wahi moment hota hai jab silence comfort se zyada burden lagne lagta hai.

PHASE II— DISTANCE

CHAPTER 3 —

FEAR OF LOSING

Fear of losing ek sudden feeling nahi hota.

Yeh tab start hota hai jab tum kisi ko “important” bolne se pehle hi unko apni routine mein include kar chuke hote ho, bina is realization ke ki ab tumhara normal unki presence se quietly attached ho chuka hai.

Phir ek point aata hai jahan tumhe pata bhi nahi hota aur tum kisi ke replies, presence aur tone ke according apna mood decide karne lagte ho.

Aur tum is dependency ko pehle normal samajhte ho.

Kyuki kuch bhi officially defined nahi hota.

But problem yahi hoti hai...

Jo officially nahi hota, woh mentally kabhi kabhi sabse zyada powerful ho jata hai.

Ek din tumhare saath kuch achha hota hai.

Koi funny moment.

Koi achievement.

Koi random thought.

Aur bina soche tumhara pehla instinct hota hai unhe batana.

Phir ek second ke liye tum ruk jaate ho.

Kyuki tumhe yaad aata hai ki ab pehle jaisi baat nahi rahi.
Aur shayad wahi chhota sa pause pehli baar tumhe dara deta hai.

Kyuki fear usually tab start nahi hota jab koi chala jata hai.

Fear tab start hota hai jab tumhe lagta hai ki shayad sab pehle jaisa nahi raha.

Aur us feeling ka koi proof bhi nahi hota.

Bas kuch moments hote hain jo ignore karna mushkil ho jata hai.

Ek din tum chat kholte ho aur kuch likhne ke baad delete kar dete ho.

Ek din tum kisi baat par unka opinion sunna chahte ho... phir sochte ho rehne do.

Ek din tum realize karte ho ki pehle jo cheezein naturally share ho jaati thi, ab unke liye reason dhoondhna pad raha hai.

Aur yahi woh silent shift hota hai jahan se cheezein change hona start karti hain.

Kyuki uske baad tum conversations ko sirf experience nahi karte.

Tum unhe interpret karte ho.

Tone kaisi thi.

Interest pehle jaisa tha ya nahi.

Distance sach mein hai ya sirf tumhare dimag mein.

Aur dheere dheere insaan relationship mein kam aur interpretation mein zyada rehne lagta hai.

Reality wahi rehti hai.

Par meaning badhta chala jata hai.

Phir tum khud ko samjhate ho.

“Main overthinking kar raha hoon.”

Par agla thought aata hai,

“Ya phir main bas woh notice kar raha hoon jo change ho raha hai.”

Aur dono thoughts equally convincing lagte hain.

Koi bhi completely galat nahi lagta.

Aur yahi jagah hoti hai jahan clarity dheere dheere disappear karne lagti hai.

Bas questions reh jaate hain.

Aur sabse frustrating part yeh hota hai ki tum kisi ko explain bhi nahi kar sakte.

Kyuki technically kuch hua hi nahi hota.

Na distance.

Na argument.

Na ending.

Bas ek feeling

Ek shift.

Jiska proof tumhare paas nahi hota.

Sirf experience hota hai.

Aur shayad yahi jagah hai jahan fear born hota hai.

Loss ka nahi.

Control ke slip hone ka.

Kyuki tum samajhne lagte ho ki jis cheez ko tum casually apni life ka part samajhne lage the...

Woh kabhi officially tumhari thi hi nahi.

Aur phir fear sirf emotion nahi rehta.

Woh behaviour banne lagta hai.

Tum zyada available rehne lagte ho.

Zyada explain karne lagte ho.

Zyada samajhne lagte ho.

Kabhi kabhi itna zyada ki tum khud ko ignore karna start kar dete ho.

Pehle tum kuch cheezon par seedha mana kar dete the.

Ab tum sochte ho,

“Chalo koi baat nahi.

Phir dobara.

Phir dobara.

Aur ek point ke baad tum compromise nahi kar rahe hote...

Tum bas aadat bana chuke hote ho.

Aur sabse dangerous part yeh hota hai ki yeh sab itna gradually hota hai ki tumhe change dikhai bhi nahi deta.

Tumhe lagta hai tum connection maintain kar rahe ho.
Lekin kabhi kabhi tum sirf khud ko peeche rakh rahe hote ho.
Thoda thoda.
Roz.
Invisible sacrifices isi liye heavy lagte hain.
Kyuki woh ek din mein hurt nahi karte.
Woh accumulate hote rehte hain
Silently.
Phir kabhi kabhi tum overcare karne lagte ho.
Zyada effort.
Zyada patience.
Zyada understanding.
Sirf is hope mein ki connection stable rahe.
Par irony yeh hoti hai ki jahan care comfort banana chahiye...
Wahi care pressure banne lagti hai.
Aur pressure quietly distance create karta hai.
Phir ek din realization aata hai.
Tum lose nahi kar rahe.
Tum pehle hi khud ko gradually dilute kar chuke ho.
Aur phir wahi cycle repeat hota hai.
Fear.

Adjustment.

Overcare.

Confusion.

Distance.

Aur phir ek stage aati hai jahan sadness bhi nahi rehti.

Bas exhaustion rehti hai.

Woh exhaustion jahan tum kisi ko hold bhi nahi kar paate...

Aur chhod bhi nahi paate.

Kyuki tum attachment aur self-preservation ke beech atak jaate ho.

Tab shayad pehli baar samajh aata hai ki kuch connections force se maintain nahi hote.

Jo naturally grow karte hain, unhe constantly prove nahi karna padta.

Aur jo constantly prove karne padte hain...

Woh aksar sabse pehle thak jaate hain.

Maybe that's the difference between fear and awareness.

Fear hold karna chahta hai

Awareness release karna sikha deti hai.

Fear control dhoondhta hai.

Awareness acceptance.

Aur shayad healing wahi se start hoti hai...

Jab tum kisi aur ke jaane se pehle...

Khud ke paas wapas aana start kar dete ho.

CHAPTER 4 —

EMOTIONAL EXHAUSTION

Attachment jab start hoti hai, sab kuch exciting lagta hai.

Har conversation interesting.

Har notification noticeable.

Har interaction meaningful.

Par human mind ek cheez bahut der tak same intensity par carry nahi kar sakta.

Aur shayad isi liye emotional exhaustion ek din mein nahi aati.

Woh build hoti hai.

Slowly.

Almost invisibly.

Pehle tum wait karte ho.

Phir tum overthink karte ho.

Phir tum understand karne ki koshish karte ho.

Phir tum situation ko fix karne ki.

Aur phir ek point ke baad...

tum bas thak jaate ho.

Not physically.

Emotionally.

Strange thing is, emotional exhaustion ka starting point usually kisi bade heartbreak se nahi aata.

Kayi baar woh un cheezon se aata hai jo kabhi properly resolve hi nahi hui.

Un conversations se jo half-finished reh gayi.

Un questions se jinke answers kabhi mile hi nahi.

Un situations se jahan tum continuously samajhne ki koshish kar rahe the ki actually chal kya raha hai.

Aur confusion ek limit ke baad sadness se zyada exhausting ho jaati hai.

Kyuki sadness kam se kam clear hoti hai.

Confusion nahi.

Confusion insaan ko continuously mentally active rakhti hai.

Aur mind kabhi rest nahi kar pata.

Shayad tumne bhi notice kiya hoga.

Kabhi kabhi kisi person ke saath kuch major wrong nahi hua hota.

Phir bhi tum mentally drained feel karte ho.

Unka naam dekh kar excitement nahi aati.

Par indifference bhi nahi aata.

Bas ek ajeeb sa emotional fatigue feel hota hai.

Jaise mind bol raha ho:

"Main aur process nahi kar sakta."

Aur yahin se emotional exhaustion ka real phase start hota hai.

Tum care karna band nahi karte.

Tum bas constantly care karne ki capacity lose karne lagte ho.

Reply aata hai.

Tum dekhte ho.

Par us excitement ke bina jo pehle hua karti thi.

Silence aata hai.

Par us panic ke bina jo pehle aa jata tha.

Aur pehli baar tum realize karte ho ki shayad problem feelings ki nahi thi.

Problem un feelings ko continuously carry karne ki thi.

Kayi log emotional exhaustion ko moving on samajh lete hain.

Par dono same cheez nahi hain.

Moving on mein clarity hoti hai.

Emotional exhaustion mein bas energy khatam ho jaati hai.

Tumhare paas sochne ke liye thoughts hote hain.

Feel karne ke liye emotions hote hain.

Par unhe carry karne ki strength nahi bachi hoti.

Aur shayad sabse dangerous part bhi wahi hota hai.

Kyuki bahar se sab normal lagta hai.

Tum kaam kar rahe hote ho.
Logon se mil rahe hote ho.
Conversations bhi kar rahe hote ho.
Par internally tumhara mind constantly overloaded rehta hai.
Jaise background mein bahut saare tabs open ho.
Koi bhi actively use nahi ho raha.
Par sab energy consume kar rahe hain.
Phir dheere dheere insaan change hona start karta hai.
Woh zyada explain karna chhod deta hai.
Zyada react karna chhod deta hai.
Zyada expect karna chhod deta hai.
Logon ko lagta hai woh emotionally cold ho gaya hai.
Par reality mein woh cold nahi hua hota.
Woh tired hua hota hai.
Bahut tired.
Aur kabhi kabhi sabse exhausted log woh hote hain jo bahar se sabse normal dikhte hain.
Kyuki unhone apna breakdown loudly nahi kiya hota.
Unhone bas quietly sab andar carry kiya hota hai.
For too long.
Aur phir ek din realization aata hai.
Not dramatic.

Not life-changing.

Bas ek simple realization.

Ki har cheez ko continuously hold karke nahi rakha ja sakta.

Kuch emotions ko solve karna zaroori nahi hota.

Kuch emotions ko sirf accept karna padta hai.

Aur shayad emotional exhaustion ka hidden lesson bhi yahi hai.

Mind kabhi kabhi pain se nahi thakta.

Mind resistance se thakta hai.

Har cheez ko samajhne ki koshish se.

Har cheez ko control karne ki koshish se.

Har cheez ko bachaye rakhne ki koshish se.

Aur jab insaan finally ye struggle chhod deta hai...

tab pehli baar usse silence heavy nahi lagta.

Silence peaceful lagna start ho jata hai.

PHASE III — DETACHMENT

CHAPTER 5 — DETACHMENT (THE QUIET DISAPPEARANCE)

Detachment kabhi suddenly nahi hota.

Insaan ek din uth kar decide nahi karta ki,

"Ab mujhe farak nahi padta."

Aisa sirf movies mein hota hai.

Reality mein detachment bahut dheere dheere aata hai.

Itna dheere ki kai baar insaan ko khud bhi nahi pata chalta ki woh change ho raha hai.

Pehle jis cheez ne poora din affect kar diya hota tha...

ab woh kuch minutes tak hi mind mein rehti hai.

Pehle jiska reply na aaye toh overthinking start ho jaati thi...

ab delay notice toh hota hai, par mind uske around poori story create nahi karta.

Aur shayad wahi pehli sign hoti hai.

Not that you stopped caring.

But that you stopped revolving around it.

Strange thing is...

bahut log detachment ko coldness samajhte hain.

Jaise insaan ko suddenly feelings hi nahi rahi.

Par actual detachment waisa nahi hota.

Detachment usually tab start hota hai jab insaan bahut der tak feel kar chuka hota hai.

Bahut der tak wait kar chuka hota hai.

Bahut der tak samajhne ki koshish kar chuka hota hai.

Aur phir ek point ke baad uska mind quietly thak jaata hai.

Not from the person.

From the constant emotional effort.

Aur phir dheere dheere kuch cheezein change hona start karti hain.

Pehle har notification check karna zaroori lagta tha.

Ab phone side mein reh jaata hai.

Pehle free time milte hi mind us person ki taraf chala jaata tha.

Ab thoughts kahin aur jaane lagte hain.

Pehle har silence uncomfortable lagti thi.

Ab wahi silence thodi peaceful lagne lagti hai.

Aur yahi shift confusing bhi hoti hai.

Kyuki tumhe lagta hai shayad tum change ho gaye ho.

Par reality mein...

tum bas emotionally survive karna seekh rahe hote ho.

Maybe that's why detachment itna misunderstood hota hai.

Kyuki bahar se dekho toh sab normal lagta hai.

Tum baat bhi karte ho.

Reply bhi karte ho.

Smile bhi karte ho.

Lekin andar woh intensity nahi rehti jo pehle hua karti thi.

Aur sabse strange part?

Tumhe us intensity ki kami bhi feel nahi hoti.

Kyuki ek point ke baad peace excitement se zyada valuable lagne lagti hai.

Aur phir dheere dheere tum notice karte ho ki tumhara focus wapas khud par aana start ho gaya hai.

Un cheezon par jo tumne ignore kar di thi.

Un habits par jo kahin beech mein chhoot gayi thi.

Un parts par jo attachment ke beech dheere dheere disappear ho gaye the.

Aur shayad detachment ka real purpose bhi wahi hota hai.

Kisi aur se door jaana nahi.

Khud ke paas wapas aana.

Kyuki kabhi kabhi insaan kisi person se attach hote hote apne aap se hi disconnect ho jaata hai.

Aur jab detachment aata hai...

toh woh sirf us person ko release nahi karta.

Woh us version ko bhi release karta hai jo constantly wait kar raha tha.

Constantly overthink kar raha tha.

Constantly kisi aur ki presence mein apni peace dhund
raha tha.

Aur phir ek din tum realize karte ho...

tum unhe miss nahi kar rahe.

Tum us feeling ko miss kar rahe the jo unke saath feel hoti
thi.

Aur dono mein bahut difference hota hai.

Kyuki log hamesha nahi rehte.

Feelings bhi nahi.

Par jo lessons woh chhod jaate hain...

woh kaafi der tak saath rehte hain.

Aur shayad detachment ka final stage wahi hota hai.

Jab memory rehti hai...

par weight chala jaata hai.

Jab naam yaad rehta hai...

par dard nahi.

Jab story yaad rehti hai...

par usme phir se jeene ki zarurat mehsoos nahi hoti.

Aur tab pehli baar samajh aata hai...

detachment kisi ko bhool jaana nahi hota.

Detachment woh point hota hai jahan kisi ki presence
tumhari peace define karna band kar deti hai.

Aur shayad wahi moment hota hai...

jahan healing quietly begin karti hai.

CHAPTER 6 —

EMOTIONAL SHUTDOWN

What happens when a person gets tired of feeling everything too deeply?

What happens when the heart slowly stops reacting... not because it healed, but because it carried too much for too long?

And what if the most dangerous breakdown is the one nobody notices... not even the person living through it?

Emotional shutdown kabhi suddenly nahi hota.

Insaan ek din uth kar emotionally numb nahi ban jaata.

Yeh dheere dheere hota hai.

Too much overthinking.

Too much emotional pressure.

Too much mental noise.

Aur bahut der tak sab kuch andar hi andar carry karte rehne ke baad.

Shayad isi liye bahut log samajh hi nahi paate ki unke andar exactly change kya ho raha hai.

Because breakdown visible hota hai

Shutdown invisible.

Breakdown mein insaan toot ta hua dikh jaata hai.

Shutdown mein insaan bas dheere dheere feel karna kam kar deta hai

Aur yahi uski dangerous beauty hoti hai.

Ek point ke baad insaan itna emotionally overloaded ho jaata hai ki uska mind automatically intensity reduce karna start kar deta hai.

Not because pain khatam ho gaya

But because system thak chuka hota hai.

Jaise continuously jalta hua bulb ek waqt ke baad dheere dheere dim hone lagta hai...

Waise hi emotions bhi apni brightness lose karne lagte hain.

Aur yahi emotional shutdown ka real beginning hota hai.

Pehle har cheez matter karti thi.

Replies matter karte the.

Presence matter karti thi.

Silence hurt karta tha.

Ek message mood change kar deta tha.

Ek dry text pura din affect kar deta tha.

Lekin phir ek strange shift aata hai.

Ab wahi conversations utna effect nahi karti

Wahi songs utna hit nahi karte.

Wahi cheezein jo pehle emotional reaction laati thi... ab bas pass hokar nikal jaati hain.

Aur pehle insaan confuse hota hai.

"Am I healing?"

"Ya main bas feel karna band kar raha hoon?"

Aur dono possibilities ek saath sach lagti hain.

Kabhi kabhi emotional shutdown itna subtle hota hai ki insaan khud bhi usse miss kar deta hai.

Pehle jo gaane repeat pe chalte the, ab woh khatam ho jaate hain aur tumhe yaad bhi nahi rehta ki suna kya tha.

Kabhi phone unlock karte ho aur kuch seconds baad realize hota hai ki unlock kisliye kiya tha wohi yaad nahi.

Kabhi kisi purani chat tak pahunch jaate ho.

Kuch lines padhte ho.

Thodi der rukte ho.

Phir bina kisi reason ke wapas aa jaate ho.

Not because it doesn't matter.

Because react karne ki energy nahi bachi hoti.

Kabhi favourite movie chal rahi hoti hai aur tum pura scene dekh kar bhi mentally kahin aur hote ho.

Kabhi log tumse baat kar rahe hote hain aur tum genuinely sun bhi rahe hote ho

phir bhi kuch andar register nahi karta.

Jaise body present ho.

Par attention kahin aur atka hua ho.

Aur shayad yahi emotional exhaustion ka sabse strange symptom hota hai.

Insaan busy rehta hai.

Functional rehta hai.

Normal bhi lagta hai.

Par internally woh kisi cheez mein fully present nahi hota.

Kyuki jab emotions continuously heart pe pressure banate rehte hain...

toh ek waqt ke baad dil bhi awaaz kam kar deta hai.

Feelings disappear nahi hoti.

Bas background noise ban jaati hain.

Jaise baarish band nahi hoti...

bas aadat pad jaati hai bheegne ki.

Shayad emotional shutdown ka sabse dangerous part bhi wahi hota hai.

Outside se sab normal lagta hai.

Insaan uthta hai.

Kaam karta hai.

Logon se baat bhi karta hai.

Kabhi kabhi hasta bhi hai.

Lekin internally sab muted hota hai.

Jaise emotions ka volume low ho gaya ho.

Na excitement properly feel hoti hai.

Na sadness properly release hoti hai.
Bas ek emotional flatness.
Ek ajeeb sa internal silence.
Aur isi wajah se bahut log emotionally struggling insaan ko
identify hi nahi kar paate.
Kyuki woh visibly broken nahi lagta.
Woh bas disconnected lagta hai.
Aur kahi baar woh khud bhi nahi samajh pata ki uske
andar chal kya raha hai.
Kyuki emotions completely gone nahi hote.
Bas locked ho jaate hain.
Aur locked emotions sabse zyada heavy hote hain.
Kyuki woh bahar nahi aate.
Woh andar collect hote rehte hain.
Jaise band kamre mein dheere dheere smoke fill hota rehta
hai
Bahar se sab same dikhta hai.
Andar saans lena mushkil hota rehta hai.
Dheere dheere insaan feel karna avoid karna start kar deta
hai.
Deep conversations exhausting lagne lagti hain.
Old chats avoid hone lagti hain.

Songs skip hone lagte hain.
Photos ignore hone lagti hain.
Memories trigger banne lagti hain.
Kyuki har emotional trigger usse wapas usi jagah le jaata
hai jahan se woh mushkil se nikla hota hai.
Aur phir ek aur strange cheez grow karti hai.
Numbness safe lagne lagti hai.
Kyuki jab insaan feel nahi karta...
toh hurt bhi kam hota hai.
Lekin problem yahi hoti hai.
Jab insaan pain shut karta hai...
toh dheere dheere happiness bhi fade hone lagti hai.
Aur phir life survival mode ban jaati hai.
Not living.
Just existing.
Wake up.
Stay busy.
Distract yourself.
Avoid thoughts.
Sleep tired.
Repeat.

Aur dheere dheere insaan khud ko observe karna bhi kam kar deta hai.

Woh mirror mein khud ko dekhta hai...

par connect nahi kar pata.

Jaise body present ho.

Par andar ka insaan kahin background mein chala gaya ho.

Phir ek aur silent shift aata hai.

Insaan emotionally available rehna band kar deta hai.

Not intentionally.

Automatically.

Isi liye emotionally exhausted log kabhi kabhi cold lagte hain.

Detached lagte hain.

Uninterested lagte hain.

Lekin reality mein woh emotionless nahi hote.

Woh emotionally tired hote hain.

Bahut zyada tired.

Aur shayad isi liye silence comfortable lagne lagta hai.

Dark room.

Headphones.

Rain sounds.

Late night walks.

Nature.

Isolation.

Kyuki nature judge nahi karta.

Silence expectations nahi rakhta.

Aur darkness explanations nahi maangti.

Aur dheere dheere insaan logon se zyada apne thoughts ke saath rehna start kar deta hai.

Lekin problem yeh hoti hai...

jab insaan bahut der tak apne hi mind ke andar rehne lagta hai...

toh memories reality se zyada loud ho jaati hain.

Old conversations replay hone lagti hain.

Past moments loop mein chalne lagte hain.

Aur insaan unknowingly present se disconnect hona start kar deta hai.

Isi stage pe bahut log bolte hain:

"Main theek hoon."

Lekin internally woh theek nahi hote.

Woh bas emotionally offline hote hain.

Jaise kisi ne unke andar ka emotional switch temporary pause pe daal diya ho.

Par emotional shutdown ka matlab yeh nahi hota ki insaan permanently broken ho gaya.

Kabhi kabhi yeh bas ek silent signal hota hai.
Ki insaan bahut der se survive toh kar raha hai...
par properly breathe nahi kar raha.
Aur healing ka first step emotions ko forcefully fix karna
nahi hota.
First step hota hai honestly accept karna:
"Haan... main emotionally tired hoon."
Kyuki jo insaan apni emotional state ko samajh leta hai...
woh dheere dheere usse recover bhi kar leta hai
Not suddenly.
Not magically.
Bas slowly.
Khud ko sunna start karke.
Khud pe pressure kam karke.
Aur har feeling se bhaagna band karke
Aur shayad healing ki pehli sign happiness bhi nahi hoti.
Bas itna hota hai ki ek din tum sunset dekh kar ruk jaate
ho.
Ek gaana phir se achha lagne lagta hai.
Ek joke pe genuinely hasi aa jaati hai.
Ek conversation ke baad energy drain nahi hoti.
Aur tab realize hota hai...

shayad emotions wapas ek saath nahi aate.

Woh dheere dheere laut te hain.

Bilkul waise hi...

jaise woh gaye the.

Quietly.

Kyuki numbness healing nahi hoti.

Numbness bas ek temporary shelter hota hai after too much emotional damage.

Real healing tab start hoti hai jab insaan firse safely feel karna seekhta hai...

bina khud ko lose kiye.

PHASE IV — VOID

CHAPTER 7 — ISOLATION

(SELF-DISTANCE)

Kabhi kabhi insaan duniya se door nahi hota.
Woh khud se door ho jaata hai.
Aur shayad dono cheezon mein bahut farq hota hai.
Logon se distance banana easy hai
Phone silent kar do.
Replies late kar do
Bahar jaana kam kar do.
Lekin khud se distance..
woh itna easily notice nahi hota.
Woh dheere dheere hota hai.
Almost invisible
Pehle tumhe pata hota tha tum kya feel kar rahe ho
Sad ho
Angry ho.
Confused ho.
Excited ho.
Kuch toh clear hota tha.
Phir ek point aata hai jahan koi poochta hai,

"Tu theek hai?"

Aur tum genuinely nahi jaante kya answer dena hai.

Kyuki problem yeh nahi hoti ki tum jhoot bol rahe ho

Problem yeh hoti hai ki tumhe khud nahi pata hota andar
chal kya raha hai.

Shayad self-distance ka beginning wahi hota hai

Jab insaan apne emotions ko samajhna band kar deta hai

Woh feel toh sab kuch kar raha hota hai..

par identify kuch nahi kar paata.

Bas ek heaviness.

Ek pressure.

Ek constant mental weight.

Jiska source clear nahi hota.

Kabhi notice kiya hai?

Kuch log physically present hote hain..

par mentally kahin aur.

Conversation chal rahi hoti hai.

Woh sun bhi rahe hote hain

Reply bhi kar rahe hote hain.

Par attention poori tarah wahan nahi hoti.

Jaise dimag background mein kisi aur jagah atka hua ho.

Kabhi kabhi baat khatam hone ke baad realize hota hai ki
saamne wale ne pichle do minute mein kya bola tha...

tumhe yaad hi nahi

Tum wahan the.

Par actually wahan nahi the

Aur dheere dheere yeh state normal lagne lagti hai.

Insaan khana kha raha hota hai...

par taste notice nahi karta.

Music sun raha hota hai...

par lyrics andar tak nahi jaate.

Kisi favourite cheez ke saamne baitha hota hai...

par excitement feel nahi hoti.

Aur shayad sabse strange cheez yeh hoti hai...

tum sad bhi nahi hote.

Bas interested hona kam ho jaata hai.

un cheezon mein bhi...

jinhe kabhi tum genuinely love karte the.

Yahi isolation ka dangerous part hai.

Tum akela feel nahi karte.

Tum disconnected feel karte ho.

Difference bahut bada hai.

Pehle free time peaceful lagta tha.

Ab free time uncomfortable lagne lagta hai.
Kyuki free time mein distractions kam ho jaate hain.
Aur asli awaaz sunai dene lagti hai.
Apni.
Isi liye bahut log unnecessarily busy rehne lagte hain
Kuch na kuch.
Koi bhi cheez.
Bas thodi der ke liye dimag chup ho jaaye.
Lekin thoughts ki ek strange habit hoti hai.
Jitna unhe ignore karo...
utna hi woh raat ko wapas aate hain.
Aur phir ceiling stare karte karte purani baatein yaad aati
hain.
Purane log.
Purani conversations.
Purane versions of yourself.
Woh version jo zyada hasta tha.
Zyada trust karta tha.
Zyada alive feel karta tha.
Aur phir ek uncomfortable question dimag mein aata hai:
"Kya life badli hai...
ya main badal gaya hoon?"

Aur kai baar jawab sunna utna easy nahi hota.
Kyuki kuch changes ek din mein nahi aate
Woh bahut pehle start ho chuke hote hain.
Un baaton se jo kabhi properly boli nahi gayi.
Un feelings se jo kabhi properly samjhi nahi gayi.
Aur un expectations se...
jinhe insaan khud bhi accept nahi karna chahta tha.
Kabhi kabhi insaan mirror mein khud ko dekhta hai...
aur ek second ke liye genuinely feel karta hai:
"Main pehle jaisa kyun nahi raha?"
Aur sabse strange part?
Uske paas answer bhi hota hai.
Bas woh answer dobara face nahi karna chahta.
Kyuki kuch memories answers nahi deti.
Sirf thaka deti hain.
Insaan ek din mein nahi badalta.
Woh har din thoda thoda shift hota hai.
Aur ek din peeche mudkar dekhta hai...
toh khud ko pehchanne mein time lagta hai.
Jaise face wahi ho.
Par andar wala insaan nahi.
Self-distance ka matlab yeh nahi hota ki insaan khud se
nafrat karta hai.

Kabhi kabhi woh bas khud ko sunna band kar deta hai.
Apni needs ignore kar deta hai.
Apni feelings postpone kar deta hai.
Apne questions avoid kar deta hai.
Aur dheere dheere apni hi life mein spectator ban jaata hai.
Participant nahi
Kabhi kabhi insaan logon ko lose karne se pehle...
apni curiosity lose karta hai.
Woh excitement jo chhoti cheezon mein milti thi.
Woh interest jo naye logon, naye ideas aur naye
experiences mein hota tha.
Aur jab curiosity chali jaaye...
toh duniya wahi rehti hai.
Bas usse dekhne wala insaan badal jaata hai.
Isi liye kuch log bolte hain:
"Sab theek hai."
Lekin andar se woh jaante hain...
sab theek nahi hai.
Bas sab familiar ho gaya hai.
Difference bahut bada hai.
Kyuki insaan har cheez ki aadat daal sakta hai.
Even emptiness.

Even loneliness.

Even emotional distance.

Aur shayad isi liye self-distance itna dangerous hota hai.

Woh pain ki tarah attention demand nahi karta

Woh quietly settle ho jaata hai.

Routine ban kar.

Personality ban kar.

Lifestyle ban kar.

Aur phir ek din insaan realize karta hai...

woh duniya se nahi bhaag raha tha.

Woh khud se bhaag raha tha.

Lekin shayad isi phase ki ek achhi baat bhi hai.

Ek point ke baad insaan thak jaata hai bhaagte bhaagte.

Aur phir pehli baar rukta hai.

Khud ko solve karne ke liye nahi.

Khud ko samajhne ke liye.

Kyuki har cheez ka answer immediately milna zaroori nahi hota.

Kabhi kabhi sirf itna samajh lena kaafi hota hai ki andar kya chal raha hai.

Aur shayad wahi se cheezein dheere dheere change hona start karti hain.

Kyuki end mein isolation ka opposite company nahi hota.

Isolation ka opposite connection hota hai.

Aur sabse important connection...

hamesha khud ke saath hota hai.

PHASE V— AWARENESS

CHAPTER 8 —

THE MIND QUESTIONS ITSELF

Kabhi kabhi insaan suddenly break nahi hota.

Woh dheere dheere apne hi dimaag ke andar kho jaata hai

Exactly waise hi jaise attachment suddenly nahi hua tha.

Pehle kisi ki presence achhi lagti hai.

Phir woh important lagne lagti hai.

Phir unki absence notice hone lagti hai.

Phir overthinking.

Phir emotional exhaustion.

Phir silence.

Aur phir ek point aata hai...

jahan insaan pehli baar khud ko question karna start karta hai.

Na unhe.

Na situation ko.

Khud ko

Aur shayad awareness wahi se start hoti hai.

Kabhi kabhi insaan kisi aur ko miss nahi kar raha hota.

Woh us version ko miss kar raha hota hai jo woh unke saath tha.

Aur dono cheezon mein bahut farq hota hai.

Kyuki kai baar person chala jaata hai...

par dard uske jaane ka nahi hota.

Dard uss feeling ka hota hai jo uske saath chali gayi.

Woh excitement

Woh curiosity.

Woh reason jiske wajah se phone unlock karte hi mood thoda better ho jaata tha.

Woh feeling ki din mein kuch toh hai jiska wait hai.

Aur phir ek din insaan khud se poochta hai:

"Kya main usse miss kar raha hoon...

ya main khud ko miss kar raha hoon?"

Aur shayad yeh awareness ka pehla uncomfortable question hota hai.

Kyuki iske baad blame karna mushkil ho jaata hai.

Phir story kisi aur ke baare mein nahi rehti.

Phir story khud ke baare mein ho jaati hai.

Kabhi kabhi awareness kisi deep conversation se nahi aati.

Woh tab aati hai jab tum randomly ek purani chat open karte ho.

Pehle ek message padhte ho.

Phir doosra.

Phir teesra.

Aur achanak realise karte ho...

ki pichle 15 minute se tum messages nahi padh rahe the.

Tum woh feeling dhoondh rahe the...

jo kabhi un messages ke saath aati thi

Aur us moment pehli baar samajh aata hai...

shayad tum person ko nahi...

ek waqt ko miss kar rahe ho.

Kabhi notice kiya hai?

Jab hum hurt hote hain...

toh hum answers dhoondhte hain.

Lekin jab hum bahut zyada hurt ho jaate hain...

toh hum questions dhoondhna start kar dete hain.

"Kya problem mere andar thi?"

"Kya main zyada attach ho gaya tha?"

"Kya main logon ko unki reality se zyada importance de deta hoon?"

"Kya mujhe unki yaad aati hai..."

ya mujhe unki presence ki aadat pad gayi thi?"

Aur yeh woh questions hain...

jinke answers kisi aur ke paas nahi hote.

Friends ke paas nahi.
Internet ke paas nahi.
Kyuki kuch answers sirf observation se milte hain.
Khud ko honestly dekhne se.
Without defending yourself.
Without creating excuses.
Without editing the truth.
Aur shayad adulthood ka sabse painful moment bhi wahi
hota hai...
jab tum realise karte ho ki tumhara sabse bada enemy koi
aur nahi tha.
Tumhara unhe lekar banaya hua version tha.
Tumne assumptions banayi
Future imagine kiya
Unspoken promises maan liye.
Permanent cheezon ki expectations rakh li.
Aur phir reality ne quietly aake poocha
"Maine yeh promise kab kiya tha?"
Aur us moment pehli baar samajh aata hai...
ki pain hamesha reality nahi deti.
Kai baar pain expectations deti hain.
Woh expectations jo kabhi boli hi nahi gayi thi.

Sirf imagine ki gayi thi.
Kabhi awareness itni simple bhi hoti hai.
Favourite song play hota hai.
Wahi song.
Wahi lyrics.
Wahi headphones.
Sab kuch same.
Lekin is baar woh andar tak nahi jaata.
Aur tum realise karte ho...
song change nahi hua.
Tum change ho gaye ho.
Aur kai baar growth exactly aisi hi feel hoti hai.
Exciting nahi.
Bas strange.
Jaise purana ghar dekhne wapas jao..
aur pata chale ghar wahi hai.
Bas tum woh insaan nahi rahe jo kabhi usme rehta tha.
Phir ek aur realization aata hai.
Tum poori journey mein logon ko samajhne ki koshish
karte rahe...
par khud ko kabhi properly observe hi nahi kiya.
Tumhe pata tha kisne ignore kiya.

Tumhe pata tha kisne disappoint kiya.
Tumhe pata tha kisne distance create kiya.
Par tumhe yeh nahi pata tha...
ki tum khud ko kitne time se ignore kar rahe the
Kitne time se apni needs postpone kar rahe the.
Kitne time se apni emotional stability kisi aur ki
consistency pe rakh chuke the
Aur shayad isi liye jab woh person change hua..
toh tumhari poori internal balance hil gayi.
Kabhi awareness kisi grand realization ki tarah nahi aati.
Woh ek random afternoon mein aati hai.
Jab tum khidki ke bahar dekhte ho...
aur realise karte ho ki pichle kuch mahino se tum sirf
survive kar rahe the.
Je nahi rahe the.
Kabhi woh late night aati hai.
Jab tum ceiling dekhte hue achanak samajhte ho..
ki tum itne time se answers galat jagah dhoondh rahe the.
Aur kabhi woh mirror ke saamne aati hai.
Jab tum khud ko dekh kar genuinely sochte ho
"Main itna thak kyun gaya hoon?"
Aur pehli baar jawab kisi aur ka naam nahi hota.

Khud ka hota hai.

Aur phir ek aur uncomfortable cheez samajh aati hai.

Hum aksar closure isliye nahi dhoondhte kyuki hum answers chahiye hote hain.

Hum closure isliye dhoondhte hain kyuki hum chaahte hain ki jo story humne apne dimaag mein banayi thi...

woh kisi tarah complete ho jaye.

Mind incomplete cheezon ko pasand nahi karta

Isi liye woh purani conversations replay karta rehta hai.

Purane moments revisit karta rehta hai.

Jaise kahin na kahin koi missing piece mil jayega

Par kai baar missing piece hota hi nahi.

Kai baar story bas wahi khatam ho gayi hoti hai...

jahan hum accept nahi karna chahte the.

Awareness ka strange part yeh hai...

yeh answers nahi deti

Yeh illusions todti hai

Woh illusions jo comfortable the.

Woh stories jo humne khud ko sunayi thi.

Woh narratives jinke andar rehna reality dekhne se aasaan tha.

Aur jab woh sab girta hai...

toh pehle confusion aata hai.

Phir silence.

Phir resistance.

Aur phir dheere dheere clarity

Not about them.

About yourself

Phir tum realise karte ho..

ki life ka sabse bada battle kisi aur ko samajhne ka nahi
tha.

Khud ko samajhne ka tha.

Kis cheez se tum attach hote ho.

Kis cheez se tum toot jaate ho.

Kis cheez se tum bhaagte ho.

Aur kis cheez ko accept karne se darte ho

Healing shayad us din start nahi hoti jab tum kisi ko bhool
jaate ho.

Healing shayad us din start hoti hai...

jab tum unke baare mein sochte ho...

aur pehli baar tumhara focus unpar nahi hota.

Khud par hota hai.

Tum yeh nahi sochte

"Unhone aisa kyun kiya?"

Tum yeh sochte ho:

"Maine is experience se kya seekha?"
Aur shayad wahi awareness ka final form hai.
Jab insaan answers ke peeche bhaagna chhod deta hai...
aur observation ke saath jeena seekh leta hai.
Kyuki end mein peace clarity se nahi aati.
Peace acceptance se aati hai
Aur acceptance tab aata hai...
jab insaan finally khud ke paas wapas laut aata hai
Slowly.
Quietly.
Without pretending.
Without running.
Without losing himself again.

PHASE VI —
THE LAST SHIFT

CHAPTER 9 —

THE THINGS WE REALIZE TOO LATE

Kabhi notice kiya hai...

insaan puri life cheezein collect karta rehta hai

People.

Memories.

Dreams.

Attention.

Achievements.

Aur phir waqt dheere dheere usse ek ajeeb truth samjha deta hai:

jin cheezon ko hum "hamesha" samajhte hain...

unmein se zyada kuch bhi permanent nahi hota.

Bachpan mein lagta hai school kabhi khatam nahi hoga.

Ghar humesha waise hi rahega.

Dost humesha paas rahenge

Parents humesha strong rahenge.

Par phir ek din school khatam ho jaata hai.

Ek dost stranger ban jaata hai.
Ghar wahi rehta hai...
par uske andar ke log badal jaate hain.
Aur parents ke baalon mein safedi achanak nahi aati...
bas hum der se notice karte hain.
Shayad life ka sabse strange part bhi wahi hai.
Changes loudly nahi aate.
Woh quietly accumulate hote rehte hain.
Aur phir ek din tum peeche mudkar dekhte ho..
aur realise karte ho ki poori duniya nahi...
tumhari poori duniya badal chuki hai.
Kabhi purane photos dekhe hain?
Us waqt woh bas normal photos lagte the.
Koi special moment nahi.
Koi emotional background music nahi.
Bas ek random day.
Random people.
Random smiles.
Lekin saalon baad wahi photo dekhkar realise hota hai...
ki us frame mein maujood aadhe log ab life mein hi nahi
hain.
Aur us moment samajh aata hai:

kai baar hum jis waqt ko normal samajh kar jee rahe hote hain...

wahi baad mein life ke most valuable memories ban jaate hain

Aur shayad isi liye life samajh mein tab aati hai...

jab uska ek hissa haath se nikal chuka hota hai

Kabhi kabhi insaan bahut late realise karta hai ki life actually complicated thi hi nahi

Humne khud usse complicated bana diya.

Itna future socha...

ki present properly jee hi nahi paaye.

Itna fear carry kiya...

ki peaceful moments notice hi nahi kiye.

Itna prove karne mein lage rahe...

ki experience karna bhool gaye

Aur phir ek point ke baad priorities quietly change hona start karti hain.

Pehle attention important lagta tha.

Ab peace important lagta hai.

Pehle impress karna important lagta tha.

Ab protect karna important lagta hai.

Pehle log kya sochenge matter karta tha.

Ab yeh matter karta hai ki raat ko sone se pehle andar kitna shor hai.

Aur strange part yeh hota hai...
jis akelapan se insaan pehle bhaagta tha..
kabhi kabhi wahi usse sabse honest lessons deta hai.
Silence mein koi impress nahi karna padta.
Koi role play nahi karna padta
Koi mask maintain nahi karna padta.
Bas tum hote ho...
aur tumhare thoughts
Aur wahi pe bahut saare illusions tootne lagte hain.
Bahut saare fears imaginary nikalte hain.
Bahut saari fights unnecessary
Bahut saari expectations self-created.
Aur phir ek aur realization aata hai...
hum aksar sochte hain ki hume log hurt karte hain
Lekin kai baar hume unke baare mein banayi hui apni
stories hurt karti hain.
Woh expectations jo kabhi boli hi nahi gayi.
Woh futures jo kabhi promise hi nahi hue.
Woh versions jo reality mein exist hi nahi karte the.
Aur awareness ka painful part bhi wahi hai.
Woh comfort nahi deti.

Woh clarity deti hai.
Aur clarity har baar achhi feel nahi hoti.
Kabhi kabhi clarity bas itna batati hai...
ki tum itne time se galat direction mein answers dhoondh
rahe the.
Isi phase mein loneliness bhi alag feel hone lagti hai
Yeh sirf akela hona nahi hota.
Yeh woh feeling hoti hai...
ki tum logon ke beech ho..
par fully present nahi ho.
Festival chal raha hota hai.
Sab enjoy kar rahe hote hain
Aur tum achanak observe karte ho...
ki tum participate kam aur observe zyada kar rahe ho.
Music chal raha hota hai.
Par tum lyrics se zyada apne thoughts sun rahe hote ho.
Sab kuch ho raha hota hai..
par andar koi aur process chal raha hota hai.
Aur phir ek dangerous thought aata hai:
"Shayad pehle jab main kam samajhta tha...
tab main zyada jeeta tha."
Par yahin ek paradox hai.

Na innocence wapas aati hai.
Na ignorance.
Ek baar jo dekh liya...
usse phir unseen nahi kiya ja sakta.
Isi liye maturity koi achievement nahi lagti.
Woh ek accumulation lagti hai.
Enough endings.
Enough disappointments
Enough waiting.
Enough temporary people.
Enough lessons
Aur phir insaan dheere dheere samajh jaata hai...
har cheez ko hold karna zaruri nahi hota
Har cheez ko explain karna zaruri nahi hota.
Har cheez ko control karna zaruri nahi hota.
Life dheere dheere simple lagna start karti hai.
Ek cup chai
Ek silent evening.
Ek genuine conversation.
Ek walk bina phone ke.
Ek raat jahan dimag unnecessary wars na lad raha ho.
Aur phir shayad sabse deep realization aata hai...

insaan puri life duniya ko samajhne ki koshish karta rehta hai..

aur end mein usse pata chalta hai...

ki sabse difficult cheez khud ko samajhna thi

Apne fears.

Apni attachments.

Apni insecurities.

Apni expectations.

Aur apni reality

Aur shayad isi liye...

jo insaan bahut deeply feel karta hai...

woh eventually chhoti cheezon mein jeena seekh jaata hai.

Ek calm morning.

Ek honest smile.

Ek peaceful night.

Ek moment jahan kuch prove nahi karna hota.

Aur phir last truth quietly saamne aata hai...

life ko samajhna mushkil nahi tha.

Hum bas usse feel karna bhool gaye the.

CHAPTER 10 —

THE LAST SHIFT

Kabhi kabhi lagta hai...
hum jo life mein feel karte hain na...
woh sab random nahi hota.
Us waqt random lagta hai
Par baad mein realise hota hai...
ki har cheez kisi aur cheez se connected thi.
Ek conversation.
Ek silence
Ek attachment.
Ek disappointment
Ek goodbye
Sab alag events nahi the
Sab ek hi journey ke different chapters the.
Aur shayad isi liye distance itna important hota hai.
Kyuki jab tum kisi experience ke andar hote ho...
tab tum sirf uska weight feel karte ho
Lekin jab tum usse paar nikal jaate ho...
tab tum uska meaning dekh paate ho.

Aur phir ek pattern nazar aata hai
Har attachment ne kuch sikhaya.
Har loss ne kuch reveal kiya.
Har breakdown ne kuch remove kiya.
Aur har ending ne tumhe tumhare baare mein kuch
bataya.
Pehle lagta tha problem log the.
Phir lagta tha problem circumstances thi.
Phir lagta tha problem timing thi.
Aur ek din quietly samajh aata hai...
ki life ka sabse difficult subject hamesha khud insaan hi
tha.
Kabhi socha hai...
hum itna hold kyun karte hain?
People ko.
Moments ko.
Words ko.
Memories ko.
Shayad isliye...
kyuki hume lagta hai ki letting go ka matlab losing hota
hai.
Lekin waqt ek alag lesson deta hai.
Jo cheez jaane wali hai...

usse rokna usse bachata nahi.
Sirf tumhe thaka deta hai.
Aur phir dheere dheere insaan pakadna kam kar deta hai.
Force karna kam kar deta hai.
Har answer dhoondhna kam kar deta hai
Har cheez ka meaning nikalna bhi kam kar deta hai
Aur wahi se ek naya phase start hota hai.
Acceptance.
Not the dramatic kind.
Not the motivational kind.
Bas ek simple acceptance.
Ki kuch log chapter the.
Book nahi.
Kuch feelings lessons thi.
Destiny nahi.
Kuch roads bas experience ke liye thi.
Arrival ke liye nahi.
Aur shayad wahi maturity hai.
Jab insaan har cheez ko possess karna band kar deta hai.
Aur appreciate karna start karta hai.
Ek waqt tha...
jab future sabse important lagta tha.

Phir ek waqt aaya...
jab past sabse loud lagne laga.
Aur ab..
dono ka volume dheere dheere kam ho gaya hai
Na future ko control karna possible hai.
Na past ko rewrite karna.
Toh bachta kya hai
Yeh moment.
Bas yeh
Yeh saans.
Yeh second.
Yeh life jo abhi ho rahi hai.
Aur shayad isi realization ke baad life pehli baar simple lagti hai.
Not easier.
Just simpler.
Sky pehle bhi wahi tha.
Hawa pehle bhi wahi thi
Subah pehle bhi aati thi.
Lekin insaan pehli baar unhe notice karta hai.
Pehli baar bina kisi destination ke walk karta hai.
Pehli baar bina kisi expectation ke baat karta hai.

Pehli baar bina kisi fear ke khamoshi mein baithta hai.
Aur realise karta hai...
ki peace koi achievement nahi thi
Woh toh hamesha yahin thi.
Bas shor bahut zyada tha.
Aur phir ek aur strange realization aata hai.
Life ko samajhne ki race mein...
hum jeena bhool gaye the.
Hum answers ke peeche bhaagte rahe.
Jabki kai questions answers ke liye bane hi nahi the.
Kuch questions sirf experience karne ke liye hote hain
Kuch roads sirf chalne ke liye.
Kuch log sirf milne ke liye.
Aur kuch endings...
sirf badalne ke liye.
Aur phir ek din...
tum peeche mudkar dekhte ho.
Attachment.
Distance.
Overthinking.
Exhaustion.
Detachment.
Isolation.

Awareness.

Sab kuch

Aur pehli baar unmein se kisi ko hate nahi karte.

Kyuki ab samajh aa chuka hota hai...

ki woh sab tumhare against nahi tha

Woh sab tumhe shape kar raha tha.

Aur shayad isi liye...

"The Last Shift" kisi aur ke baare mein kabhi tha hi nahi.

Woh shift hamesha tumhare andar ho raha tha.

The person you were.

The person you became.

Aur un dono ke beech ka safar.

Aur jab yeh samajh aa jaata hai...

toh story khatam nahi hoti

Bas ek nayi layer start hoti hai.

Ek aisi layer...

jahan insaan duniya ko samajhne se pehle...

khud ko observe karna start karta hai.

Aur shayad asli journey wahi se begin hoti hai.

END OF PART I

EPILOGUE

Shayad yeh kabhi attachment ki story thi hi nahi.

Na distance ki

Na loss ki

Shayad yeh hamesha us insaan ki story thi...

jo dheere dheere khud se door chala gaya tha.

Aur phir ek din...

khud ko wapas dhoondhna start kiya.

Har chapter ki shuruaat kisi aur se hui thi.

Ek person.

Ek connection

Ek memory.

Ek silence.

Lekin har chapter ka end wahi hua..

andar.

Jahan asli conversations chal rahi thi.

Jahan asli battles ladi ja rahi thi.

Aur jahan woh questions paida ho rahe the...

jinhe koi aur kabhi dekh hi nahi sakta tha.

Shayad isi liye kuch journeys bahar se chhoti lagti hain...

par andar poori zindagi badal deti hain.
Attachment ne sikhaya ki insaan kitna deeply feel kar sakta hai.
Distance ne sikhaya ki har cheez hamesha nahi rehti.
Pain ne sikhaya ki kuch answers kabhi milte nahi.
Aur awareness ne sikhaya...
ki har answer zaroori bhi nahi hota
Kyuki ek point ke baad insaan samajh jaata hai...
ki life ko control nahi kiya ja sakta
Sirf observe kiya ja sakta hai.
Aur shayad peace wahi hoti hai.
Jab tum har cheez ko pakad kar rakhna band kar dete ho.
Aur phir bhi toot te nahi.
Jab tum kisi ko miss karte ho..
par khud ko lose nahi karte.
Jab tum silence sunte ho...
aur usse bharne ki jaldi nahi karte.
Aur phir ek din...
ek ajeeb sa moment aata hai.
Koi grand realization nahi.
Koi dramatic ending nahi
Bas ek quiet understanding.
Ki tum wahi insaan nahi rahe...

jo is journey ki shuruaat mein the.
Woh version jo answers ke peeche bhaagta tha...
jo har silence ko fill karna chahta tha...
jo har ending ko rok lena chahta tha...
shayad kahin peeche reh gaya.
Aur uski jagah koi aur aa gaya.
Thoda zyada aware.
Thoda zyada calm.
Thoda zyada real.
Aur shayad...
wahi The Last Shift tha.
Kisi aur ko lose karne ka nahi.
Khud ko wapas paane ka.
Because in the end..
har journey, har attachment, har distance...
insaan ko wahi le aati hai jahan se sab shuru hua tha.
Khud tak.

PART II — SECOND LAYER

Kabhi kabhi...
jab sab kuch finally quiet ho jaata hai...
toh ek naya question janam leta hai.
Agar main mere thoughts nahi hoon...
agar main meri emotions nahi hoon...
agar main meri memories bhi nahi hoon..
toh phir observe kaun kar raha hai?
Aur shayad...
agli journey usi question se shuru hoti hai.

TO BE CONTINUED...

~ © Lalit R. Mishra

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Lalit R. Mishra is a writer focused on the psychology of human behavior, attachment, self-awareness, emotional patterns, and the silent transformations that often go unnoticed within everyday life.

His work explores the space between thought and feeling—the questions people carry quietly, the connections they struggle to understand, and the internal shifts that shape who they eventually become.

Rather than providing conclusions, his writing invites readers to observe their own experiences through a deeper psychological lens, uncovering the patterns hidden beneath attachment, distance, loss, growth, and self-discovery.

The Last Shift is his debut work and the first installment in an ongoing exploration of the human mind and its many layers.

Because sometimes the longest journey is not towards someone else

but back to yourself.

— Lalit R. Mishra